

OTESSA 2025 Online Conference Program

May 25, 2025 @ 12:13 am PDT (UTC-07:00)

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Welcome



Figure 1: OTESSA Logo

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

! Important

Check the [OTESSA conference website for abstracts](#) and any changes to this program. Information about any changes to the program will also be available via the OTESSA Welcome Desk on the conference platform once the conference opens.

All OTESSA Participants can attend the [Congress “Big Thinking” lecture series](#). These take place each day of the conference. Congress has “[open events](#)” available as well (open to registrants across association conferences at Congress as well as those who hold community passes).

All OTESSA Registrants can also attend conference sessions offered by the [Canadian Association for the Study of Education \(CSSE\)](#), [Canadian Association for the Study of Higher Education \(CSSHE\)](#), and [Canadian Association of Learned Journals \(CALJ\)](#) as we have reciprocity agreements in place. Please note that presenters must register in each conference in which they are presenting.

Monday, June 2

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

8:30 - 9:00 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement

Location

9:00 - 10:00 | Keynote: Thomas Reeves

Location

10:00 - 10:15 | Break

10:15 - 11:15 | Concurrent Session 1

(60 Mins)

Session 1.1

Location

10:15 - 11:05 | Time Barriers for Adopting Digital Tools in Language Teachers' Practice

Research

Maryam Elshafei | *York University*

 Abstract

Session 1.2a

10:15 - 10:35 | Expectations for Generative AI Integration in Pedagogical Strategies

Research

Enas Aref et al. | *Western Michigan University*

 Abstract

Session 1.2b

10:35 - 10:55 | Evaluating Esports Tutorials through AI and Human Methods: Unpacking Learning Strategies in Open Digital Spaces

Track

Bruce Parsons et al. | *Radford University*

 Abstract

Session 1.3a

Location

10:15 - 10:35 | Reframing Presence in Fully Online Learning: Embracing Imagination, the More-than-human, and Sustainability

track

Susanna Kohonen | *University of Eastern Finland*

 Abstract

Session 1.3b

Location

10:15 - 10:35 | Modelling Students Emotional Trajectories in Course Evaluations: A Computational Framework for Enhancing Student Success

track

Christel Young et al. | *East Tennessee State University*

 Abstract

11:15 - 11:45 | Break

11:45 - 12:45 | Concurrent Session 2

(60 Mins)

Session 2.1

Location

11:45 - 12:35 | AI and Human-Centered Open Education: Sopala: An Innovative Model for K-12 Education

Research

Sadik Shahadu et al. | *Affiliation*

 Abstract

Session 2.2a

11:45 - 12:05 | Exploring the Alignment of Design Principles for K-12 Online Learning with Researched Models and Standards: Principles to Guide Engaging and Supportive Online Learning

track

Randy LaBonte et al. | *CANeLearn*

 Abstract

Session 2.2b

Location

12:05 - 12:25 | Addressing the Assumption that Online Learning is Intuitive: An OER for Learning to Learn Online

track

Kristin Petrovic et al. | *Athabasca University*

 Abstract

Session 2.2c

Location

12:25 - 12:45 | Yes, You Can: Research With Adult Trauma Survivors Who Learn Online

track

Hilary Schmidt | *Thompson Rivers University*

 Abstract

Session 2.3a

Location

11:45 - 12:05 | “Generating” Equity? Why Generative AI-Powered Education Necessitates Integration of Critical Algorithm Studies

track

Fatima Zohra | *University of Waterloo*

 Abstract

Session 2.3b

Location

12:05 - 12:25 | Exploring Students’ Perceptions, Practices, and Training Needs Regarding Generative AI

track

Marta Samokishyn et al. | *Saint Paul University*

 Abstract

12:45 - 1:00 | Break

1:00- 2:30 | Networking

Tuesday, June 3

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

10:00 - 11:00 PDT | Keynote | James Slotta - Future of Ed Tech

11:00 - 11:15 | Break

11:15 - 12:15 | Concurrent Session 3

(60 mins)

Session 3.1

Location

11:15 - 12:05 | Integrating Artificial Intelligence into a Community of Inquiry: The Roles of AI

Research

Hyeyung Park | *Athabasca University*

i Abstract

Session 3.2

Location

11:15 - 12:05 | Ethical AI in Open Education: Balancing Innovation, Accessibility, and Digital Equity

Research

Warren Wilansky | * *

 Abstract

12:15 - 12:45 | Break

12:45 - 1:45 | Concurrent Session 4

Location

Session 4.1

12:45 - 1:35 | Designing Calm: Reducing Learner Anxiety with H5P in Digital OER Textbooks

Workshop or Demo

Theresa Huff | *Loyola Marymount University*

 Abstract

Session 4.2a

Location

12:45 - 1:05 | Mid-American Conference Websites and Student Well-Being: A Content Analysis

Practice

Hui Zhan | *Ohio University*

 Abstract

Session 4.2b

Location

12:45 - 1:05 | Creating Whiteboard Animations to Explain Tooth Microanatomy

Research

Nazlee Sharmin et al. | *University of Alberta*

 Abstract

Session 4.2c

Location

1:05 - 1:25 | Developing a Mobile App for Oral Histology

Research

Nazlee Sharmin et al. | *University of Alberta*

 Abstract

1:45 - 2:00 | Break

2:00 - 3:00 | Concurrent Session 5

(60 Mins)

Session 5.1

Location

2:00 - 2:50 | Speculation: Shaping the Future of Education

Research

Danielle Dilkes | *Western University*

 Abstract

Session 5.2

Location

2:00 - 2:50 | Transformative Digital Accessibility and Post-Secondary Teaching Praxis

Workshop or Demo

Kim Ashbourne et al. | *University of Victoria*

 Abstract

Wednesday, June 4

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10:00 - 11:00 PDT | Keynote | Anatoliy Gruzd - From Prompt to Propaganda: How Generative AI Fuels Disinformation and Misinformation and What We Must Do

11:00 - 11:15 | Break

11:15 - 12:15 | Keynote | Laura Czerniewicz, Catherine Cronin, Helen Beetham

12:15 - 12:45 | Break

12:45 - 1:45 | Concurrent Session 6

(60 mins)

Session 6.1

Location

12:45 - 1:35 | Open Publishing Unplugged: Unlocking Creativity and Collaboration

Workshop

Karna Younger et al. | *Loyola Marymount University*

 Abstract

Session 6.2a

Location

12:45 - 1:05 | MicroDesign in Open/Higher Education

Research

Hilary Schmidt et al. | *Thompson Rivers University*

 Abstract

Session 6.2b

Location

1:05 - 1:25 | Virtual Reality Museums: Redefining Engagement and Understanding in Cultural Heritage

Research

Yuning Gao | *New York University*

 Abstract

Session 6.2c

Location

1:25 - 1:45 | AI as Creative Writing Coach: Exploring Human-AI Collaboration in Creative Writing Learning

Research

Cinzia Pusceddu | *Affiliation*

 Abstract

1:45 - 2:00 | Break

2:00 - 3:00 | Concurrent Session 7

Session 7.1

Location

2:00 - 2:50 | Exploring the Intersection of Agriculture, Technology, and Game-Based Learning

Workshop

Patricia Dennis | *Affiliation*

 Abstract

Session 7.2

Location

2:00 - 2:50 | Educational Pathways to Access, Support, Hope, Transformation, and Opportunities (ePASHTO)

Research

Marguerite Koole | *University of Saskatchewan*

Abstract

Thursday, June 5

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

10:00 - 11:00 PDT | Keynote | Jennifer Wemigwans - Remote from Congress in Toronto

11:00 - 11:15 | Break

11:15 - 12:15 | Concurrent Session 1 | Streamed from Victoria

(60 Mins)

Session 1.1a

Location

11:15 - 11:35 | Creating Capacity for Digital Transformation

Research

Leah Macfadyen | *University of British Columbia*

Seyyed Kazem Banihashem | *Open University of the Netherlands*

Rhiannon Lewis | *University of British Columbia*

Abstract

Globally, the demand for online education has surged, driven by the need for flexible and accessible learning (Johnson, 2023; Quality Matters, 2023) and dramatically escalated by the COVID-19 pandemic (Cui et al. 2022). In 2024, Cui et al. noted that doctoral level education in educational technology will “build critical capacity for leading research and driving transformation in policy and practice”. In this study we contend that while doctoral-level expertise and leadership is vital, it is widespread access to flexible post-graduate education and training for current and upcoming educators and practitioners that will support system-wide upskilling for ongoing digital transformation. In 2019, and in 2024, we surveyed the global landscape of masters-level education related to educational technologies and digital learning. Currently, 39 institutions offer 65 master’s degree programs in this field. Surprisingly, only eight new master’s degree programs in educational technology launched globally, post-pandemic. However, we did discover extensive curricular rebalancing. Here, we report on the current state of master’s level education in educational technology, curricular expansions in topic areas that including management, planning and leadership, research methods, technical aspects of design, data and analytics, emerging issues & technologies, and instructional strategies, and we consider how these reflect current educational needs.

Session 1.1b

11:35 - 11:55 | Cultivating GenAI Literacy – Moving Past AI Pedagogy’s Hype

Research

Gwen Nguyen | *BCcampus*

Abstract

In this session, I examine the relationship between GenAI and pedagogy in higher education, challenging the notion of AI pedagogy while advocating for critical and mindful integration of AI tools within existing pedagogical frameworks. Drawing on the recent literature on digital pedagogies and practical experiences, I argue that while AI tools can enhance educational outcomes, they cannot replace the fundamental human elements that define true pedagogy, including empathy, ethical reasoning, critical thinking, and creativity. This session aims to contribute to the ongoing dialogue about the role of AI in higher education by proposing a practical framework for cultivating AI literacy among educators while maintaining the essential human-centered approach to teaching and learning.

Session 1.2

Location

11:15 - 12:05 | Assessment for Equity: Openness and DEI in your grading architecture (WorkShop)

Workshop

Colin Madland & Jess Mitchell | *University of Victoria & Ontario College of Art and Design University*

Abstract

This workshop will provide an overview of how you can use your grading architecture (how you lead learners through activities that support their learning, and ultimately, how you arrive at a final grade) to support greater equity using openness and DEI in your assessment practice. Equity is compromised when grades are assigned based on anything other than what a learner knows or can do (e.g., arbitrary due dates, punitive policies, etc.). Openness is compromised when learners, instructors, or other stakeholders do not fully understand the meaning and implications of the grades that are assigned. Bring your syllabus and join us as we explore ways to build assessment architectures that ensure grades are assigned according to what learners know and that learners understand how to progress in their learning journey based on the feedback you provide. We will discuss the purposes of assessment, sources of inequity in grading and how to overcome them, effective communication of feedback, instructor workload, and resources to assist you in your journey into alt-grading practices that meet you where you are.

12:15 - 1:30 | Lunch

1:30 - 2:30 PDT | Keynote | George Veletsianos

2:45 - 3:45 | Concurrent Session 2

(60 Mins)

Session 2.1a

Location

2:45 - 3:05 | Social Representations of Parents from Rural Areas Regarding Access and Use of Digital Technology

Research

Pascal Gauthier, Eve Pouliot, & Patrick Giroux | *Université du Québec à Chicoutimi*

Abstract

From the very beginning of the COVID-19 pandemic, digital technologies proved to be essential for the functioning of society (INSPQ, 2021). However, behind the apparent “hyperconnectivity” of young people, they are not exempt from digital inequalities (CEFRIO, 2017), and most importantly, they are not innate experts in these technologies (Yagoubi, 2020). Moreover, parents are the closest authority figures to young people regarding the “virtual world” (Reginasari et al., 2021). On the other hand, they may experience a certain ambivalence towards digital technology. Using the conceptual framework of social representations (Moscovici, 1961, 1976), this qualitative research, originating from a master’s thesis in social work, analyzes the discourse of 10 parents living in rural areas of Saguenay-Lac-Saint-Jean during the COVID-19 pandemic. The results indicate that they acquired knowledge of videoconferencing, which allowed them to continue their daily lives and ensure their children’s education. Some were able to develop a more positive attitude towards technology, while others experienced exhaustion or fatigue related to digital usage. Additionally, parents have a techno-deterministic view of digital technology and remain under the impression that young people have abilities they themselves do not possess (the “digital native” myth). This study can help professionals better understand the digital issues faced by parents and integrate them into their practice, whether in social work or the educational field.

3:05 - 3:25 | Digital Learning for Innovative Teaching: Adopting a Competency-Based Approach

Practice

Tanya Elias | *University of Calgary*

Abstract

“The Digital Learning Competency Framework developed at Vancouver Community College organizes 21 discrete competencies into three categories and seven sub-categories. Together, these competencies delineate essential digital knowledge, skills and attitudes for instructors and other learning practitioners. Each competency is further defined at four levels of proficiency so that all learning practitioners, regardless of their starting

point, can easily engage in meaningful and applied learning paths aligned with their specific needs. These competencies are now being used to develop a Digital Learning For Innovative Teaching (DLIT) microcredential that will offer formal, for credit online learning opportunities with recognition via digital badges and a short certificate. There is also future potential for the Digital Learning Competency Framework, and an associated open challenge bank, to be used to develop and recognize less formal digital learning professional development via portfolio assessment, workshops and other formats. This session discusses the Digital Learning Competency Framework development process, its current uses and the potential to extend its use over time.

Session 2.2

Location

2:45 - 3:35 | Designing Assessment As, Of, and For Learning with GenAI tools (Workshop)

Workshop

Gwen Nguyen | *BCcampus*

Abstract

When discussing assessment, we often focus primarily on assessment of learning (summative) and assessment for learning (formative). In this interactive session, we will explore how GenAI tools can be integrated across the full spectrum of assessment practice: as, of, and for learning. The session will start with a discussion on the theoretical foundations of different types of assessment and their intersection with GenAI tools, followed by practical demonstrations of how GenAI tools can enhance assessment strategies. Participants will actively engage in designing multi-layered assessment activities that promote student engagement and autonomy, utilizing GenAI in an ethical and meaningful way.

3:45 - 4:00 | Break

4:00 - 5:00 | Concurrent Session 3

(60 mins)

Session 3.1a

Location

4:00 - 4:20 | Exploring the Opportunities and Limitations of Immersive Technologies in Education

Research

Jangchu Tenzin | *University of New Brunswick*

 Abstract

Session 3.1b

Location

4:20 - 4:40 | 3D Printing Resources for the Elementary Classroom

Research

Brittany Johnson & Krystal Yang | *University of Victoria*

 Abstract

Session 3.2

Location

4:00 - 4:50 | AI, Oh My! Teaching, Cheating, and Surviving the ChatGPT Era

Research

Jill Robinson, Jhotisha Mugon, Jessica Rourke | *University of Victoria*

i Abstract

The widespread gain in popularity of artificial intelligence, such as ChatGPT, has taken higher education by storm. This has resulted in instructors adapting their pedagogical approach, feeling pressured to continuously make changes to assessments and the ways in which they engage students. Instructors and students express various sentiments about AI, ranging from positive beliefs and excitement, to fear and uncertainty. In this session we will present concerns about the use of AI in the classroom, challenges to implementation of AI, and solutions focusing on the ethical and pedagogical use of AI in higher education.

Using data from a survey of university instructors, we will present themes from a qualitative analysis of responses to several AI and teaching-related questions, examining such things as familiarity with AI, supports needed for implementation, and trends across courses. We will also consider ethical implications and unintended consequences of technological interventions, emphasizing the importance of aligning digital tools with pedagogical goals. We discuss literature related to student engagement, academic integrity, and the evolving role of AI in education. By combining real-world perspectives from faculty with a critical review of emerging solutions, we aim to provide a balanced perspective on integrating AI technology into teaching pedagogy.

Friday, June 6

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

9:10 - 10:10 PDT | Presidential Address | Valerie Irvine (UVic) & Stephanie Moore (UNM)

10:15 - 11:15 PDT | Keynote | Jean-Paul Restoule (UVic)

11:30 - 12:30 | Concurrent Session 4

Session 4.1

11:30 - 11:35 | Instructional design analytics in practice: Converting a multi-course graduate bridging program from blended-synchronous to blended-asynchronous delivery using risk-based and qualitative research techniques

Practice

Deborah Exelby | *Athabasca University*

i Abstract

Identifying which synchronous teaching-learning activities in a blended learning program should/could be converted to asynchronous technology-enabled delivery is a real-world problem encountered by many instructional designers. Risk-based instructional design analytics are an effective, efficient, and evidence-based approach for identifying misaligned

learning outcomes and content gaps; appropriate teaching-learning activities; justifiable delivery and interaction methods; and targets to concentrate time, effort, and resources for meeting learning objectives and redesign parameters. This ‘how to’ presentation will outline a solution for restructuring an existing multi-course higher education program using a risk-based mapping process for curriculum analysis and redesign decision-making. How a current state curriculum was coded, analyzed, and reorganized using triangulation of three sequential techniques is presented: 1) mapping of program (PLO) and course learning outcome (CLO) mastery requirements based on Bloom’s taxonomy (introduce, reinforce, mastery); 2) coding PLO failure risk based on the potential impact of not learning the content to the required mastery level (low, medium, high); and 3) sorting of CLOs based on keywords, into topics (course lessons) and then into themes (courses). This session demonstrates how instructional design analytics were used successfully in real-world practice to codify and sort existing curricula for program redesign.

Session 4.2a

Location

11:30 - 11:50 | Open Access and the Habitual Use of Crown Photography of Indigenous Children: Ethical Implications

Research

Shawl-Song | *Affiliation*

Abstract

The go-to images representing the history of Canada’s Indian Residential Schools (IRS) are of identifiable Indigenous children. As technological advances afford open access to the now digitized photographs, consideration for the child’s right to agency over self is often ignored. Using a social semiotic framework, historical images present alongside paradigmatic relationships to demonstrate the gaps apparent between ethics, Copyright Canada law, child advocacy and social norms. Hundreds of unpublished analogue photographs have passed into provincial and federal archival holdings where copyright remains in perpetuity with the Crown. In cases of academic research and curriculum content design, ethics approval or community engagement are currently not needed when utilizing these images. Many of these children could still be alive today and hold no agency over the photographs. While copyright law serves to protect the creators and users of a photograph, there are no ethical guidelines for the use, dissemination or protection of images of children. This presentation concludes with the demonstration of an interactive reflexive

tool developed from the author's master's thesis. This tool facilitates ethical consideration beyond the systemic use of 'Fair Dealing for Educational Purposes' and may serve to highlight efforts around the privacy and protection of children in research and education.

12:30 - 1:45 | Lunch

1:45 - 2:05 | Publication Pathways | Michele Jacobsen (UCalgary) & Valerie Irvine (UVic)

2:05 - 2:15 | Break

2:15 - 3:15 | Session 5

Session 5.1

Location

2:15 - 2:35 | Developing the Technology-integrated Assessment Scale

Research

Colin Madland | *University of Victoria*

i Abstract

“This presentation will highlight the process of building and testing a new scale intended to help researchers understand the Technology-integrated Assessment Framework (TIAF) and how it functions in higher education. In 2024, we published a description of the development of the TIAF (Madland et al., 2024), highlighting four factors related to technology-integrated assessment: (1) assessment purposes, (2) the duty of care owed by instructors to learners, (3) factors influencing technology acceptance, and (4) assessment design. Our current work is focused on understanding how these four factors within the TIAF framework can be operationalized. We will share our process of designing the scale, including defining the key constructs, identifying parameters, and framing parameters as items on the scale. We will also share preliminary results from our pilot study using the first draft of the scale. This session will be of interest to undergraduate and graduate students as well as researchers, faculty members, and administrators seeking to refresh

their skills in scale development and anyone interested in assessment in higher education.

Session 5.2a

Location

2:15 - 2:35 | From Mobile Learning to Artificial Intelligence: Evolving UTAUT Constructs in Educational Technology Adoption

Research

Caleb Or | *Singapore Institute of Technology*

Abstract

Forthcoming

Session 5.2b

2:35 - 2:55 | The Impact of Sense of Belonging on Emotion Regulation in Online Collaborative Learning: A Cross-Case Comparison of Small Groups

Research

Yeeun Choi & Mariel Miller | *University of Victoria*

Abstract

This study explores how a sense of belonging impacts the regulation of emotion in the face of challenge during online collaboration. A cross-case analysis was conducted between two groups who experienced similar emotions during a negative experience but reported contrasting levels of sense of belonging. Data include video recordings of collaborative exams and post-exam reflections to gain in-depth qualitative insights into learners' perceptions and regulation strategies. By adopting self-regulated learning (SRL) framework, the study seeks to understand how students cope with negative experiences during collaboration, and to what extent their sense of belonging impacts their strategic management of challenges. Findings inform evidence-based guidelines for designing online collaborative learning experiences that not only support students' emotion regulation but also create supportive online environments.